



SELN Monthly Network Meeting

Key Takeaways

June 18, 2025

Overview:

- This meeting featured a Data Minute marking of the 100th Data Note, a discussion about how states use Medicaid waiver self-directed services, and notes on upcoming meetings.

Data Minute:

StateData has now published 100 Data Notes! The 100th Data Note features data about what has been written about as well as who is writing and reading data notes, including those accessing them from other countries.

- Visit the [State Data website](#) to access all 100 Data Notes.

Discussion of the Medicaid Self-Directed Services:

- The self-directed services option is a person-centered or person-directed system of services structured around what people want. It differs from agency-directed services in that service recipients or their representatives have employer authority – control over the services they receive, who provides them and under what conditions; and budget authority – responsibility for controlling how the funds in their service budgets will be used to pay for supports.
- One or more self-directed services are available in every state. Self-directed service recipients typically have the access to a supports broker who can provide information and assistance how to self-direct services. Everyone should have the opportunity to self-direct their services.

- Employment supports through self-direction allow for the person to hire a job coach they are most comfortable with and can create a more holistic approach in the workplace. Appropriate training and employee support need to be considered. Many community resources exist to support people with disabilities in the workplace.
- The current Access to Integrated Employment study from the Institute for Community Inclusion found that people feel empowered by managing their own services and tailoring them to best fit their needs. Although few states offer employment services through self-direction, those interviewed did use other self-directed services to support wrap around supports that helped them getting to and from work or attend to other tasks that helped them maintain employment. They also report that the self-directed services option is worth the extra time and effort required to manage their service plan and budget.
- In two poll questions, most members indicated having made a connection to the self-directed services lead contact in their state, and half the members reported having discussions about using self-directed services for employment.
- Members' discussion topics included staff training requirements for employment services, creating data-tracking systems, and the demographics and networks of individuals using self-directed services.

SELN Membership Survey:

The membership survey closed at the end of the day on June 20th.

Upcoming Meetings:

- July 16 (business meeting for SELN leads only)
- No August meeting
- September 17

Meeting Materials:

[Recording](#)

[Slides](#)

